



FISCAL AFFAIRS



Schweizerische Eidgenossenschaft
Confédération suisse
Confederazione Svizzera
Confederaziun svizra

Swiss Confederation

Federal Department of Economic Affairs,
Education and Research EAER
State Secretariat for Economic Affairs SECO

Introduction to Gender Budgeting

MAY 27, 2026

Lauren Keating

Resident Advisor, FAD, IMF (lkeating2@imf.org)

The views expressed in the presentation are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily represent the views of the IMF, its Executive Board, or IMF management

Overview

- I. Quiz
- II. Overview of IMF Gender Budgeting
- III. Four Principles of Gender Budgeting
- IV. Four Principles – Applied Examples

Before we start the quiz...

- Who here has heard of gender budgeting?
- Who here thinks they can describe what it is?

II. Overview of Gender Budgeting

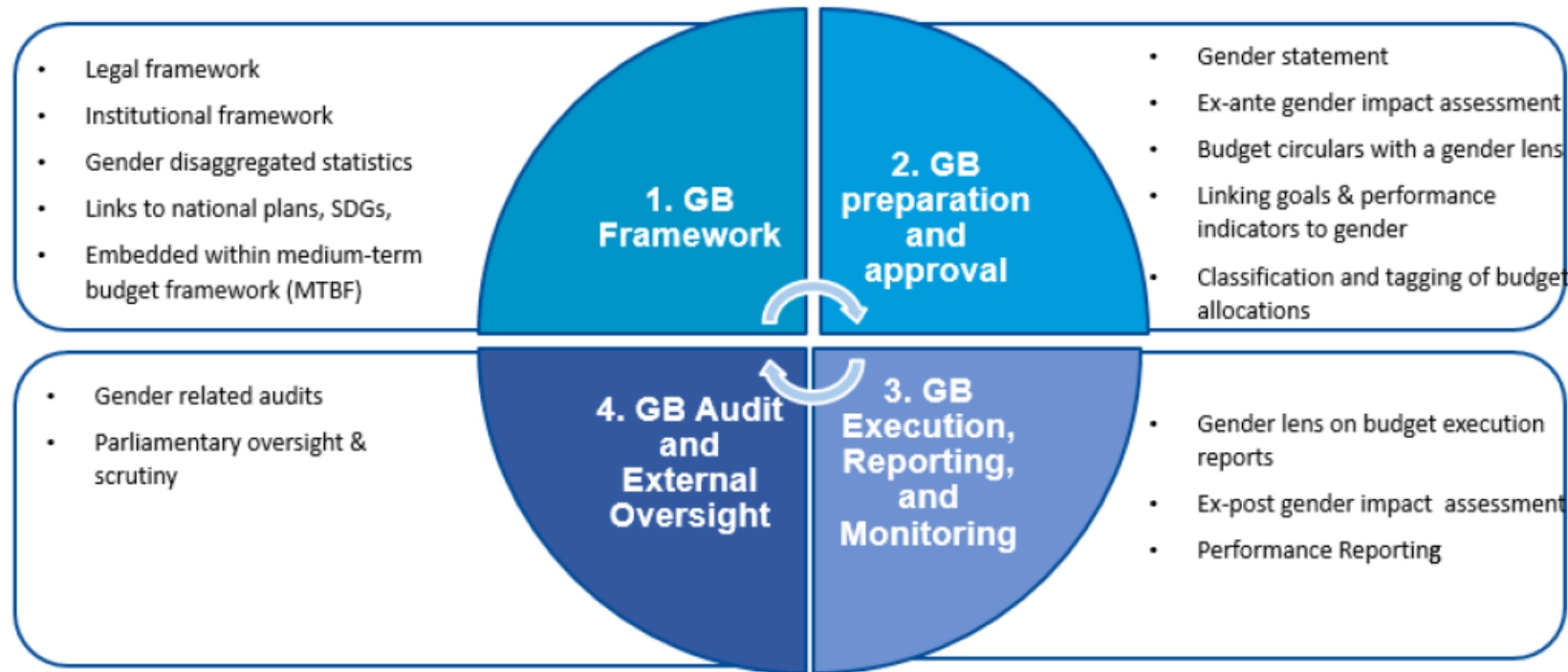
What is Gender Budgeting?

Will this budget improve gender equality? Will it leave gender inequalities as they are? Or will it worsen gender equality?

- **Definition:** The use of **fiscal policy and public financial management** to advance gender equality.
- **Key outcomes:**
 - Improving budget decision making - **resources are used efficiently and effective** towards achieving government gender equality goals.
 - Ensure the budget is **advancing gender equality, whenever possible.**

Many tools/practice integrated into the budget cycle...

The IMF approach to GB encourages the holistic integration of a gender equality perspective across each phase of the budget cycle



Source: IMF Gender Budgeting in G20 countries

Gender budgeting practices are integrated into the existing budget cycle

GB Framework and Planning

- **National gender equality goals:** Found in national development plans or gender equality policies
- **Institutional coordination mechanisms in budget preparation:** Coordination between the MoF and Ministry of Gender Equality. Focal points in line ministries. Gender-disaggregated data.
- **Legal framework:** Incorporating gender equality into public finance laws.

Budget Preparation and Approval

- **Budget Circulars:** Instructions and guidelines from the Ministry of Finance to line ministries to prepare the budget considering gender equality impacts.
- **Ex-ante Gender Impact Assessments:** A tool to assess the expected impact (direct or indirect) of a budget proposal on gender equality with the objective of improving its design and informing decision making.
- **Gender Budget Statements:** Document that accompanies budget documentation. It highlights gender inequalities and budget measures designed to address these inequalities.
- **Gender tagging:** Tags are applied to budget measures identified as advancing gender equality so they can be tracked through implementation and reported on.

Gender Budgeting is Integrated into the Existing Budget Cycle

Budget Execution, Reporting and Monitoring

- **Budget reports (in-year, end-year):** includes financial information on expenditure and revenues which advance gender equality
- **Ex-post gender impact assessments (GIAs):** A tool to assess the actual impacts (direct or indirect) of a budget measure, during or after implementation, on gender equality. Used to inform funding renewals or adjusting the measure during implementation.
- **Performance reporting:** Includes performance information on expenditures and revenues which advance gender equality.



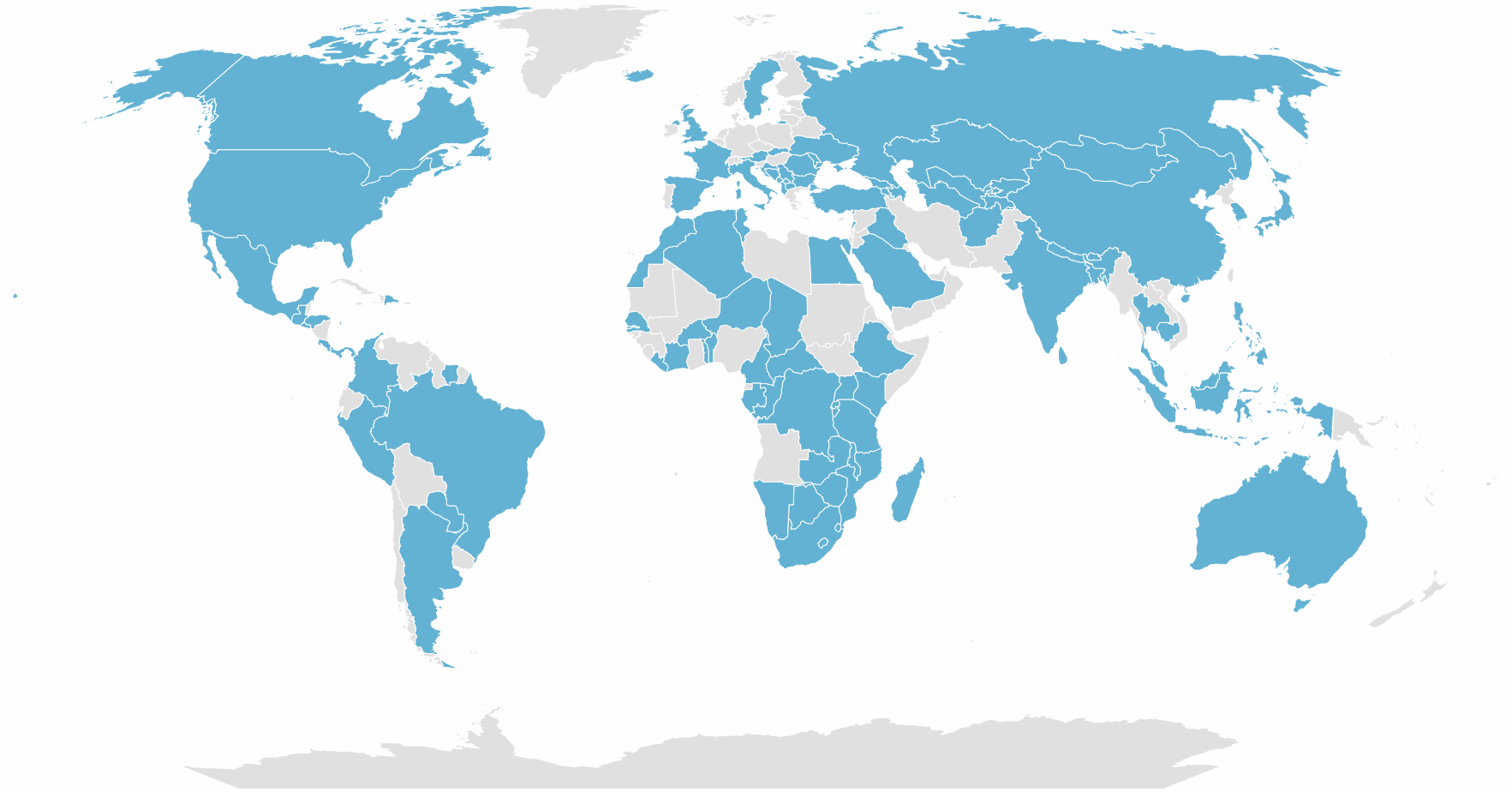
Audit and Oversight

- **External auditing.** The role of Supreme Audit Institutions (SAI) in conducting financial, performance, or compliance audits on programs or policies advancing gender equality or on the gender budgeting reform writ large.
- **Parliamentary oversight and scrutiny:** Discussion of the budget's implications for gender equality.

III. Regional Trends

IMF's Gender Budgeting Survey and Database

- **111 Countries***
 - 34 Sub-Saharan African countries
- **38 question survey** completed by government officials covering the budget cycle
- Used as the **basis for analytical** work and regional comparison

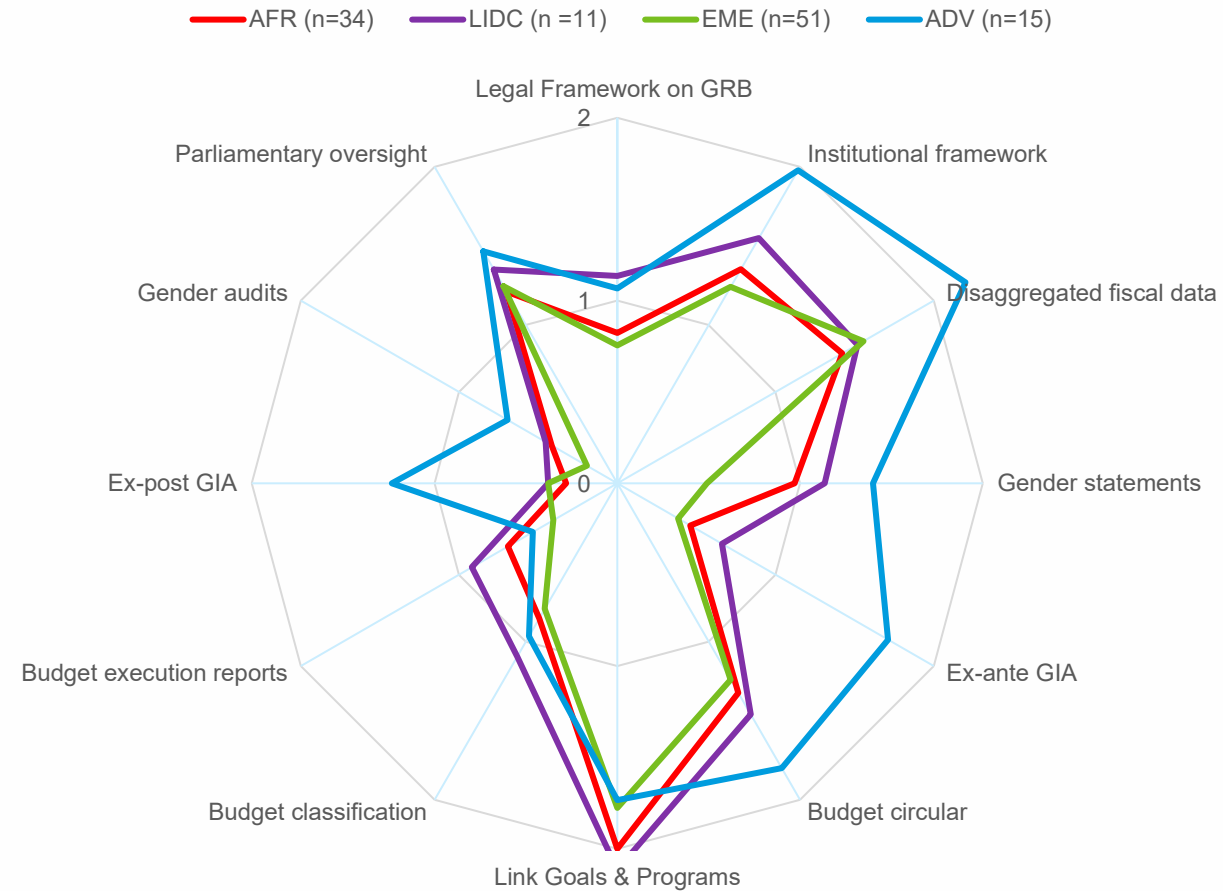


Source: IMF Gender Budgeting Survey

© Australian Bureau of Statistics, GeoNames, Microsoft, Navinfo, Open Places, OpenStreetMap, Overture Maps Foundation, TomTom, Zenrin
Powered by Bing

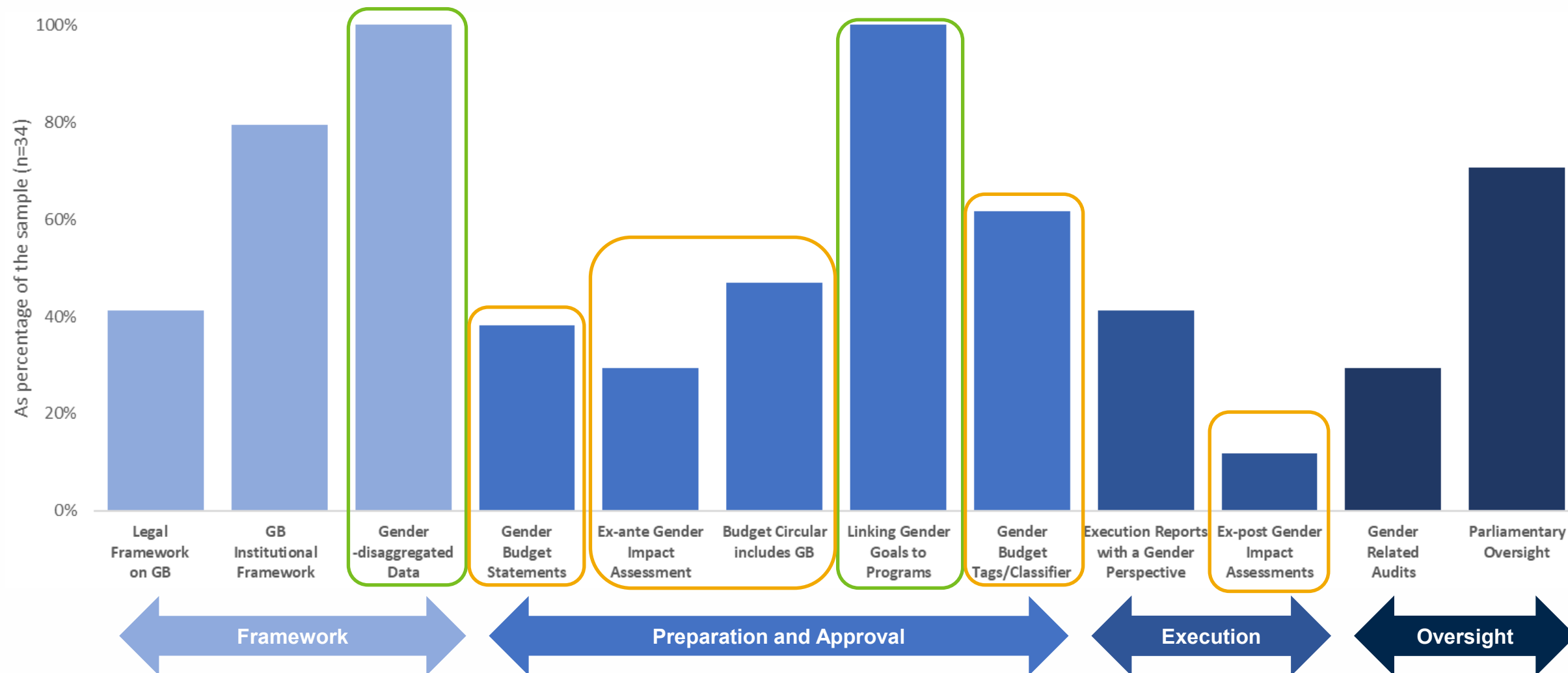
A Global Picture of Gender Budgeting

Gender Budgeting Practices – AFR vs. Other Countries by Income Groups

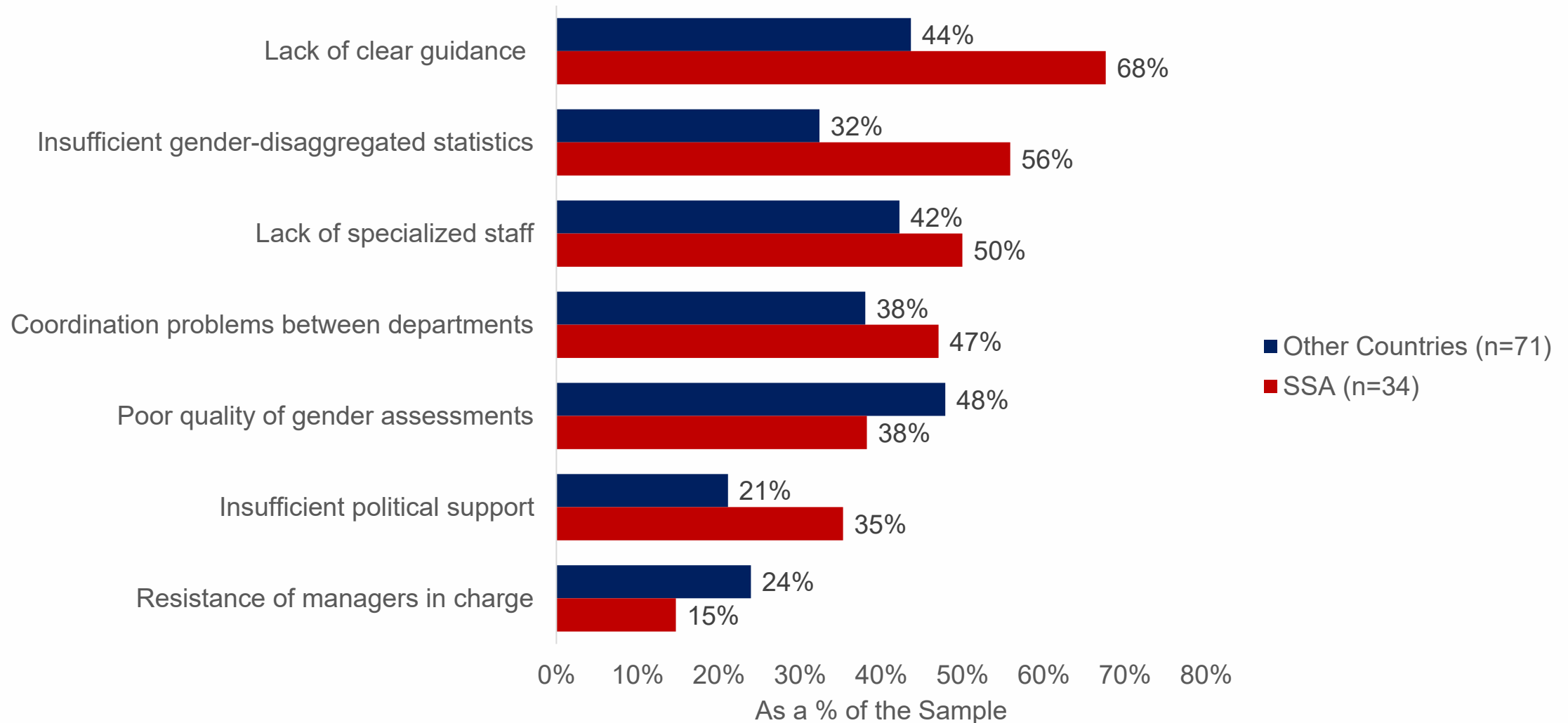


Sub-Saharan Africa – Gender Budgeting Practices

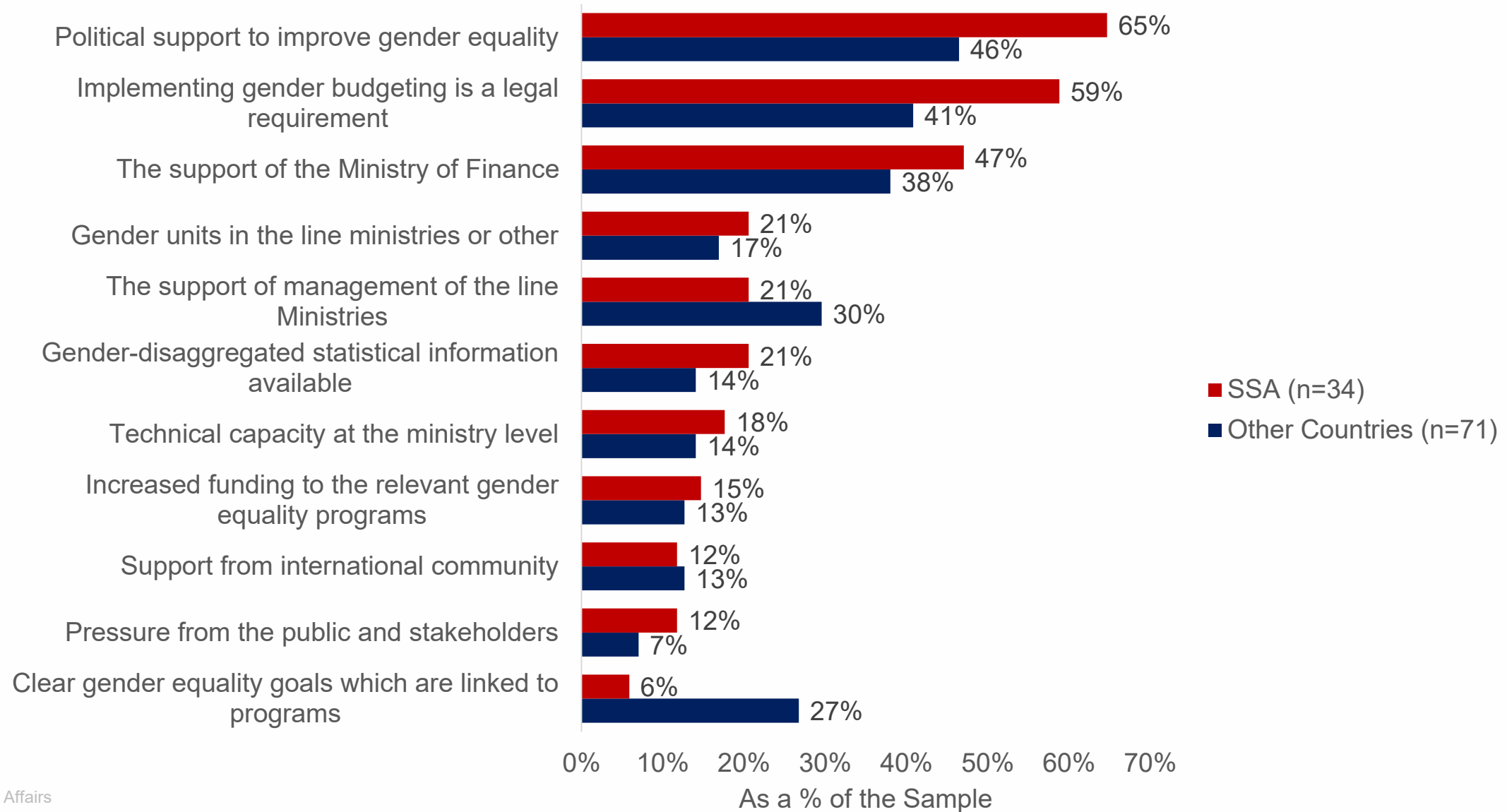
- Focus has been on gender budgeting frameworks, some budget preparation and oversight
- **Opportunity for greater implementation** of key gender budgeting tools



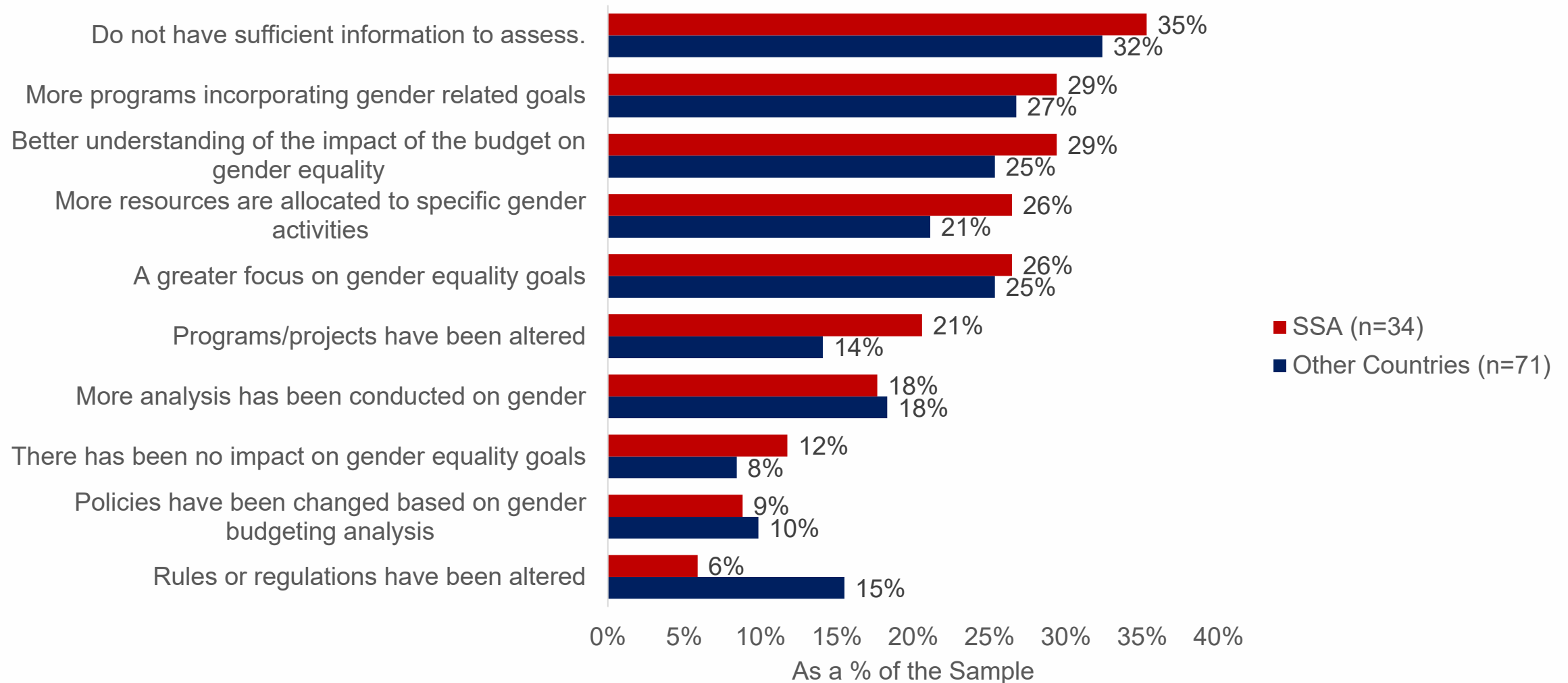
Major Challenges Encountered when Implementing Gender Budgeting



Important Factors for Success

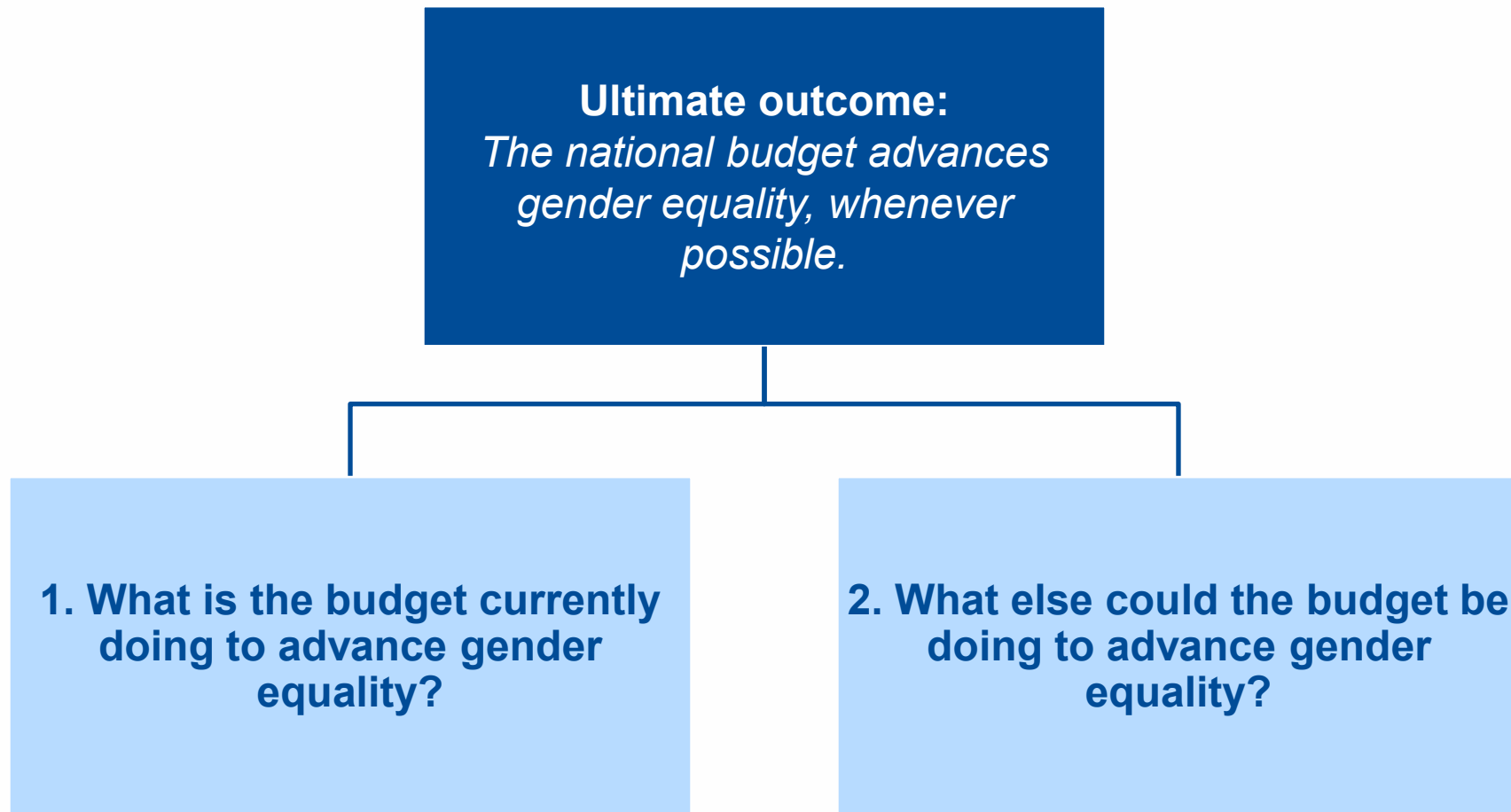


Impact of Gender Budgeting

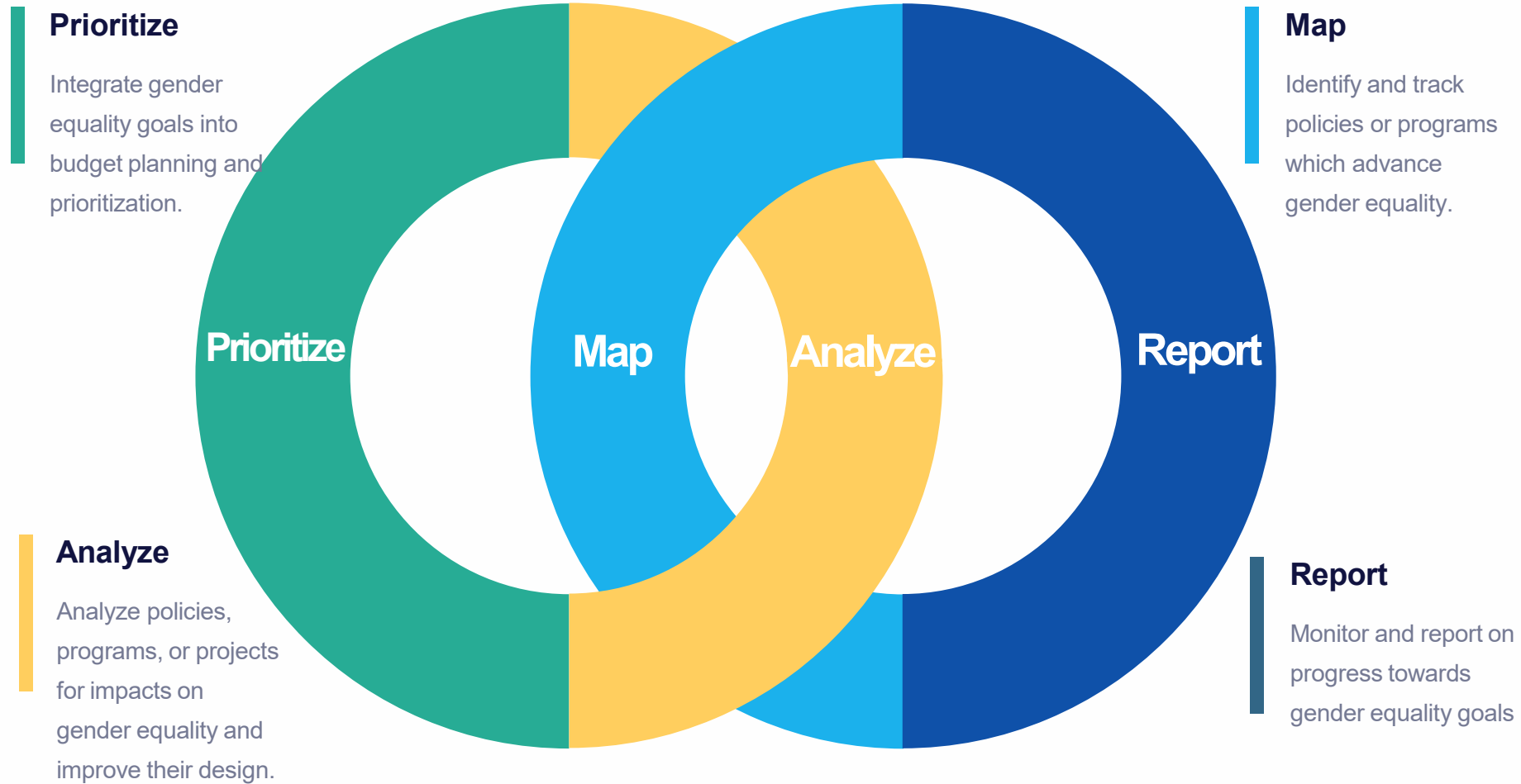


III. Four Principles of Gender Budgeting for an Effective Reform

Recall - Gender Budgeting's Ultimate Outcome



Four Principles of Gender Budgeting



Budget Institutions & Associated Gender Budgeting Practices

Four Principles



Prioritize

Budget Institutions

- National and sectoral plans
- Annual/Medium-term Budget Frameworks
- Budget call circular/guidance



Gender Budgeting Practices

- National or Sectoral Gender Equality Goals and Indicators
- Gender equality informs annual and/or medium-term budget framework
- Budget circular with a gender lens



Map

- Budgeting structure for tagging
- Financial tracking



- Gender budget tagging
- Gender lens on budget execution



Analyze

- Ex-ante policy, program, and project analysis
- Fiscal risk analysis
- Spending reviews
- Ex-post policy, program, and project evaluations



- Ex-ante gender impact assessments
- Gender perspective in spending reviews
- Ex-post gender impact assessments



Report

- Budget documentation
- Financial monitoring and reporting
- Performance monitoring and reporting
- External audits
- Legislative Oversight



- Gender budget statement
- Gender perspective in budget execution reports
- Gender perspective in performance reports.
- External gender Audits
- Legislative oversight (on gender equality)

Remember: Gender budgeting is built into, not on top of, existing budget institutions.

III. Four Principles – Applied Examples



Prioritize

Prioritize Gender Equality Goals

What are my country's gender equality goals?

Gender Equality Goal:

Women's Economic Empowerment*

Objectives:

Increase women's economic participation and control and ownership over assets (financial/non-financial)

Improve business outcomes for women owned businesses

Key Inequalities

- Gender pay gap: women earn 20% less than men on average

- 70% of women owned businesses are micro enterprises vs. only 20% of men owned businesses

- Women comprise 60% of farm laborers but only 15% of farm owners

- Majority of women owned farms are small-scale farms (limited access to inputs).

- Only 36% of women own a bank account compared to 50% of men.

**Note: General example – east African country averages*



Map

Map Budget Measures

What are ministries doing to advance gender equality?

Recall: only 15% of farm owners are women and women owned farms are small-scale.

<i>Resources</i>	<i>Ministry, Department, or Agency</i>	<i>Description: Policy or Program</i>
<i>[X] billion RWF</i>	Land Management and Use Authority	Implementation of a land rights reform policy that guarantees equal land rights for women by requiring spouses to be registered as co-owners of joint property (E.g., Rwanda)
<i>[X] million ZAR</i>	Department of Environmental Affairs	Farmer2Market project aims to prepare South African small-scale farmers to access markets through training on good agricultural practices and food safety standards (e.g., South Africa).
<i>[X] billion KSh</i>	State Department for Gender and Affirmative Action	A Women Enterprise Fund which provides affordable credit to women entrepreneurs , including those in agriculture (E.g., Kenya)



Analyze Budget Measures

How can resources be better leveraged to advance equality?

Program description:	<i>Equipment rental program – improving access to machinery so farmers can expand production.</i>
Ministry responsible:	<i>Ministry of Agriculture, Food, and Rural Affairs (South Korea)</i>
I. Are men or women more likely to rent agriculture machinery?	When reviewing this program, the ministry found way more male farmers than female farmers were renting machinery (relative to respective populations i.e., 70% of male farmers vs. 30% of female farmers).
II. Why?	Women owned farms are smaller on average and the type of equipment they needed wasn't available for rent. Additionally, women didn't have the capital to transport machinery to their farms.
III. What adjustments could be made so that the program supports national gender equality goals?	To increase the use of machinery rentals by women farmers the program included different types of machinery as part of the inventory to be rented and included transportation services so rented machinery could be delivered to the farms.



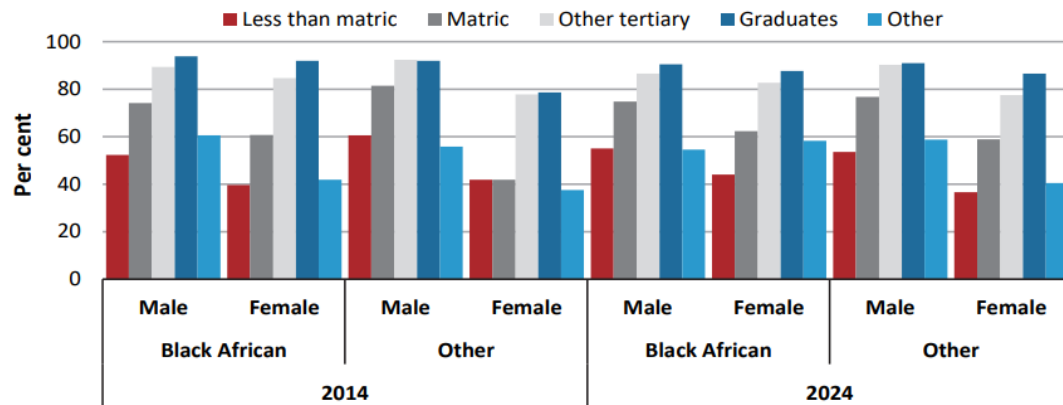
Report

Report on Government Actions

Monitor and report on progress towards gender equality goals and government actions.

GENDER BUDGET STATEMENT

Figure 1. Labour force participation rate by sex, population group and educational attainment



Source: Stats SA, 2024

- Monitor and report on progress towards gender equality goals
- Monitor and report on government actions which have been mapped or analyzed
- Make reports public.



[South Africa's 2025 Gender Budget Statement](#)

GENDER BUDGET STATEMENT

PILOT DEPARTMENT'S BUDGET INTERVENTIONS – ACTIVITIES ADVANCING WOMEN'S ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT

Table 1. Summary of mainstream expenditure for activities relating to Women's Economic Empowerment

R'000	2025/26	2026/27	2027/28
Department of Higher Education and Training	31 994 287	33 464 112	34 979 471
Department of Employment and Labour	3 644	3 826	4 017
Department of Sports, Arts, and Culture	27 939	27 973	28 003
Department of Trade, Industry, and Competition	200 000	250 000	300 000
Department of Women, Youth and Person with Disabilities	418	437	457
Total	32 226 288	33 746 348	35 311 948

Source: Data represent estimates of allocations to WEE interventions by selected pilot departments

Table 2. Summary of submissions from pilot departments

Department	Program	Initiatives/interventions supporting women's economic empowerment	R'000 2025/26	R'000 2026/27	R'000 2027/28
Department of Employment and Labour	Public Employment Services	Registration, counselling and placement of female work-seekers in registered employment opportunities	3 644	3 826	4 017
Department of Women, Youth and Persons with Disabilities	Advocacy and Mainstreaming for the Rights of Women	Coordinates business skills training programme in agriculture to benefit SMMEs/Co-operatives in partnership with DALRRD and Thembelele Local municipality	104	109	114
		SDP Programme - coordinates market access program in partnership with DSBD and Lindiwe Sanitary Pads to benefit SMMEs/Co-operatives	104	109	114

Takeaway Questions...

- **What is your national budget currently doing to advance gender equality?**
- **What else could your budget be doing to advance gender equality?**
- **Which of the four principles is your government implementing? (Prioritize, Map, Analyze, Report)**
 - **Which supporting budget institutions are being leveraged? Where are your strengths?**

Thank you!
(lkeating2@imf.org)